MIL-M-9983A(USAF)
13 September 1967
SUPERSEDING
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8 November 1963

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

MULTIMETERS, CLAMP-ON

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers portable clamp-on type multimeters capable of measuring alternating current (ac) voltage and ac current.

1.2 Classification. Multimeters covered by this specification shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.2):

Type I - 0 to 300 amperes, 0 to 600 volts.

Type II - 0 to 800 amperes, 0 to 600 volts.

Type III - 0 to 1000 amperes, 0 to 600 volts.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of the specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

Military

MIL-E-17555	Electronic And Electrical Equipment And Associated Repair Parts; Preparation For Delivery Of

STANDARDS

Military

MIL-STD-130	Identification Marking Of US Military Property

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Qualification. Instruments furnished under this specification shall be products which are qualified for listing on the applicable qualified products list at the time set for opening of bids (see 4.7 and 6.3).

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3.1.1 Sample articles furnished for qualification testing shall be manufactured by the prospective supplier requesting qualification and shall be constructed of the same type parts, components, subassemblies, and by the same manufacturing processes intended to be used during production. Sample articles shall have been tested in accordance with the qualification requirements in 4.7, prior to submission for qualification testing.

3.1.2 Design changes occurring after qualification approval will require resubmission for qualification testing, unless a specific waiver is granted by the activity responsible for the qualified products list.

3.1.3 The requirements of this specification reflect the minimum characteristics and accuracy. Items that provide additional characteristics, greater accuracy and improved performance will be acceptable.

3.2 Design and construction.

3.2.1 Design. All circuitry shall exhibit sufficient stability of operating parameters to maintain calibration within the allowable tolerance, without resetting any internal controls, for the environmental and reliability conditions as specified herein. The circuitry of this equipment shall be designed to preclude the necessity of sorting or selecting of any component part from within the stated tolerance of such part, during construction, testing, or subsequent maintenance actions.

3.2.2 Construction. The instruments shall be of modular miniaturized construction wherever possible. The construction shall allow maximum accessibility to internal parts and subassemblies.

3.3 Functional description. The clamp-on multimeters, hereafter called instruments, shall be capable of measuring ac voltages to 600 volts and ac current to 1000 amperes. The measurement shall be made without interruption to the circuit being tested. The overall accuracy of the instruments shall be within ± 5 percent of full scale.

3.4 Composition. This instrument shall consist of the following items and other component parts specified herein and as required to make up a complete equipment:

a. Meter (3.5.1).

b. Range selector (3.5.2).

c. Split-core current transformer (3.5.3).

d. Test leads (3.5.4).

3.5 Performance requirements.

3.5.1 Meter.

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3.5.1.1 Meter scales. The meter scales shall be marked in dark colors on a white background and the voltage markings shall be of a color different from that for current. The scale designation (volts and amperes) shall be marked on the meter face.

3.5.1.2 Zero adjustment. A mechanical adjustment for zero setting of the meter pointer shall be provided on the front of the instruments.

3.5.1.3 Current ranges. The current ranges of the instruments shall be as follows:

Type I - 0 to 300 amperes in at least 4 ranges.

Type II - 0 to 800 amperes in at least 5 ranges.

Type III - 0 to 1000 amperes in at least 5 ranges.

3.5.1.4 Voltage ranges. The voltage ranges of the instruments shall be 0 to 600 volts in at least 3 ranges.

3.5.1.5 Frequency response. The instruments shall be calibrated for operation on 60 Hertz (Hz) circuits, but shall be usable on circuits ranging from 50 to 400 Hz.

3.5.1.6 Accuracy. The accuracy shall be within ± 3 percent of full scale for frequencies from 50 to 70 Hz, and within ± 5 percent of full scale for frequencies from 70 to 400 Hz.

3.5.1.7 Response time. The time required for the meter pointer to reach full scale deflection from zero shall be not greater than 2 seconds.

3.5.1.8 Damping factor. The damping factor is the ratio of the steady deflection to the difference between maximum momentary deflection and steady deflection, produced by an application of constant voltage or current, and shall be not less than 3.

3.5.1.9 Meter balance. The moving element of the instruments shall be balanced so that any change in the meter indication shall be not greater than 2 percent of full scale length, when the instruments are tilted to any position from the horizontal position.

3.5.1.10 Momentary overload capacity. Performance of the instruments shall not be impaired by momentary application of 3 times full scale load on any range, except that resetting of the zero adjustment may be required.

.2 Range selector.

3.5.2.1 Type. A switch shall be provided for selecting any one of the ammeter or voltmeter ranges and shall be insulated and readily accessible to the operator. The voltmeter ranges may also be selected by shifting the test leads between suitably marked recessed terminals.

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3.5.3 Split-core current transformer.

3.5.3.1 Current transformer jaws. The current transformer core shall be provided with a pivoted or hinged C-shaped section, capable of accommodating conductors up to 1 inch in diameter on the type I instruments and up to 2 inches in diameter on the types II and III instruments. The jaws shall be insulated in such a way that when in the closed position there shall be no exposed metal protruding beyond the meter case. The jaws shall be spring loaded in the closed position.

3.5.3.2 Dielectric stress. The instrument shall withstand an ac voltage of 2400 volts applied for 60 seconds between any one transformer core jaw or any one voltage test lead terminal and any other external part of the instrument. There shall be no evidence of arcing, corona, insulation failure or damage to the instrument.

3.5.3.3 Trigger. The trigger for opening the transformer jaws shall be located in a position to allow operation with the same hand holding the instrument.

3.5.3.4 Conductor position effect. The effect of moving the current conductor from the center to any position within the transformer core jaws shall not be greater than ± 2.5 percent of full scale.

3.5.4 Test leads.

3.5.4.1 Type. Two insulated, flexible voltage test leads shall be provided with each instrument. The leads shall be 5 feet long with an insulated female portion of a screw-in terminal connector on one end for a positive connection to the instrument's terminals and an insulated test clip on the other end.

3.6 Mechanical requirements.

3.6.1 Dimensions. The dimensions of the instruments shall be not greater than the following:

Type I - $7\frac{1}{2}$ inches high, 3 inches wide, 3 inches deep.

Types II and III - $14\frac{1}{2}$ inches high, $4\frac{1}{2}$ inches wide, 3 inches deep.

3.6.2 Weight. The unpacked weight of the instruments shall be not greater than the following:

Type I - $1\frac{1}{2}$ pounds.

Types II and III - 4 pounds.

3.6.3 Markings.

3.6.3.1 Panel. Panel markings shall be stamped, etched or engraved and shall be filled with a permanent material which contrasts with the color of the instrument's panel.

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3.6.3.2 Dials and switches. Dial and switch markings shall be stamped, etched or engraved and shall be filled with a permanent material which contrasts with the color of the instrument's dials and switches.

3.6.3.3 Identification of product. Equipment, assemblies, and parts shall be marked for identification in accordance with MIL-STD-130.

3.6.4 Workmanship.

3.6.4.1 General. The instruments shall be capable of meeting the design and construction requirements specified in 3.2, and shall be free from any damage or defect that could result in failure to comply with the requirements of this specification.

3.6.4.2 Detail. The workmanship shall be such that no evidence of any physical damage or defect shall be evident upon examination of assembly and fit, materials, parts, freedom from binding, wiring assembly (lacing) and insulation, soldering, impregnation of coils, markings and identification of parts, accessibility to interchangeable parts, freedom of parts from burrs and sharp edges, finishes, and external alignment of component parts and assemblies.

3.6.4.3 Controls. Operating and adjustment controls, both internal and external, shall be readily accessible, suitably arranged and of such size and construction to permit convenience and ease of operation under all service conditions. Selector switches shall have positive detent action and shall be aligned properly with their markings.

3.7 Environmental requirements. The instruments shall show no evidence of physical damage or circuitry failure and shall maintain the accuracies specified in 3.5, after being subjected to the following environmental conditions:

a. Temperature, nonoperating - Minus 54° Centigrade (C) to plus 70°C.

b. Vibration - Total displacement of 0.01 inches for 5 minutes each at 10 Hz and 50 Hz.

c. Shock - Dropping the instrument on a hardwood table top after each bottom horizontal edge is elevated 4 inches or when the horizontal axis forms an angle of 45 degrees with the table top, for a total of 4 drops.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification, where such inspections are deemed necessary, to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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4.2 Classification of tests. Examination, sampling and testing of the instruments shall be classified as follows:

a. Acceptance tests (4.4).

b. Qualification tests (4.7).

4.3 Test conditions. Unless otherwise specified herein, the instruments shall be tested under the following conditions:

a. Temperature - Room ambient, 25°C, ± 15°C.

b. Altitude - Normal ground.

c. Humidity - Room ambient up to 90 percent relative humidity.

d. Attitude - Normal operating position.

4.4 Acceptance tests. Acceptance tests shall consist of:

a. Individual tests (4.4.1).

b. Environmental tests (4.4.2).

4.4.1 Individual tests. After the instruments have been properly calibrated, each instrument shall be subjected to the individual tests specified in Table I; Group A. All of the instruments shall meet all of the requirements of the tests specified in Table I, Group A. The instruments shall meet all of the accuracies specified in 3.5, over the entire range, and shall not be limited to the conditions stated in 4.6.

4.4.2 Environmental tests. One instrument, selected at random from each production lot of 50 or less serially numbered instruments produced on a contract or order, shall be subjected to all the environmental tests specified in Table I, Group B.

4.4.2.1 Delivery and acceptance. The production lot, from which the sample is selected, shall not be submitted to the Government for acceptance and delivery until the sample has satisfactorily completed all the tests specified in Table I, Group A and Group B.

4.4.2.2 Rejection and retest. When 1 instrument from a production lot fails to meet the specification, instruments still on hand or later produced shall not be accepted until the cause and extent of failure is determined and corrected. A failure is any need to recalibrate by internal adjustment or any replacement of components, after the test is initiated, in order for the instrument to meet the requirements set forth in Section 3 of this specification. The contractor shall explain fully to the Government representative the cause of failure and the action taken to preclude recurrence. An additional sample of at least 3 instruments shall be selected from the same lot and shall be subjected to that portion of the test which produced the failure.

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TABLE I - TESTING INDEX

Test	Requirement	Test Method
Group A: Individual tests		
a. Examination of product	3.6.4	4.6.1
b. Frequency response	3.5.1.5	4.6.2
c. Accuracy	3.5.1.6	4.6.2.1
d. Response time	3.5.1.7	4.6.2.2
e. Damping factor	3.5.1.8	4.6.2.3
f. Meter balance	3.5.1.9	4.6.2.4
g. Momentary overload capacity	3.5.1.10	4.6.2.5
h. Dielectric stress	3.5.3.2	4.6.3
i. Conductor position effect	3.5.3.4	4.6.3.1
Group B: Environmental tests		
a. Temperature, nonoperating	3.7	4.8.1
b. Vibration and shock	3.7	4.8.2

4.4.2.3 Continuation of individual tests. Individual tests may be continued pending the investigation of a sampling test failure. Final acceptance of instruments on hand or later produced shall not be made until the contractor determines the cause of failure and demonstrates to the satisfaction of the procuring agency, that the instruments meet all the requirements of this specification.

4.5 Equipment required. The following items of test equipment, or units of equal or greater accuracy and range, shall be used to perform the tests. The test equipment shall conform to laboratory standards whose calibration is traceable to the prime standards at the National Bureau of Standards (NBS).

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Equipment	Model
Variable Frequency Power Supply	Empire Devices VP-1000
Current Transformer	Weston Model 327 Type 2
Hi-Pot Test Set	Any type capable of performing the required tests.
Stop Watch	Any type capable of performing the required tests.
Environmental Test Chamber	Any type capable of performing the required tests.
Vibration Test Machine	Any type capable of performing the required tests.

4.6 Test method. The following tests, or equivalent thereof (see 4.7.3), shall be performed. The tests need not be conducted in the sequence as specified herein.

4.6.1 Inspection.

4.6.1.1 Mechanical inspection. The instruments shall be visually and mechanically inspected to determine compliance with the requirements specified herein with respect to design and construction, workmanship, dimensions, weight and markings.

4.6.1.2 Functional inspection. In the performance of all tests, the instruments shall be inspected to determine compliance with the control and functional requirements set forth in Sections 3 and 4 of this specification and to the specifications as stated by the manufacturer. Particular attention shall be paid to insure that the complete range of all control functions, within the tolerance, linearity and stability requirements, can be utilized and will not necessarily be limited to the test points as specified in Section 4 of this specification.

4.6.2 Frequency response.

a. Using a 60 Hz signal source, apply a full-scale voltage to one of the instrument's ac ranges and note the meter reading.

b. While maintaining a constant amplitude with respect to the 60 Hz reference signal, change the frequency to 50 and 400 Hz and note the meter readings, which shall not be greater than ± 2 percent of the reading in a.

c. Repeat the above test on each of the instruments' voltage ranges.

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4.6.2.1 Accuracy.

a. Using a 60 Hz signal source, apply a current through a conductor. The current shall be variable over a range great enough to accommodate the type of instruments to be tested.

b. On each current range, take a minimum of 6 readings at equidistant points on the scale, including zero and full scale.

c. The accuracy of the ammeter shall be within ± 3 percent of full scale.

d. Using a 60 Hz signal source, apply a voltage to the instrument. The voltage shall be variable over a range great enough to accommodate the type of instrument to be tested.

e. Repeat step b using the voltage ranges and terminals.

f. The accuracy of the voltmeter shall be within ± 3 percent of full scale.

g. Repeat the above test at 400 Hz. The accuracy shall be within ± 5 percent of full scale.

4.6.2.2 Response time.

a. Apply an ac voltage to the instrument, sufficient to produce full scale deflection.

b. Measure the time in seconds required for the pointer to move to within 1 percent of full scale.

c. Repeat the above test 5 times and compute the average, which shall be not greater than 2 seconds.

4.6.2.3 Damping factor.

a. Using a 60 Hz signal source, apply a current through a conductor, sufficient to produce 90 percent full scale deflection on the 150 or 300 ampere range.

b. Record the maximum momentary deflection reading and the steady state reading.

c. Compute the damping factor as specified in 3.5.1.8. The damping factor shall be not less than 3.

4.6.2.4 Meter balance.

a. Set the pointer to the center of the zero scale division with the meter in the horizontal position.

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b. Tilt the meter in any direction until the maximum deviation of the pointer is determined.

c. The maximum deviation of the pointer shall be not greater than 2 percent of full scale length.

4.6.2.5 Momentary overload capacity.

a. Using a 60 Hz signal source, apply a current through a conductor, equal to 3 times full scale, on one of the ammeter ranges. Clamp the transformer jaws around the conductor.

b. Energize the cable 9 times for a duration of 1/2 second each, with 1 minute intervals between applications of power.

c. One minute following the 9th power application, energize the conductor for a 5 second period.

d. One hour following the above application of power, set the meter pointer to zero using the external zero adjustment.

e. The full scale accuracy of each ammeter range shall be checked and shall be within the limits specified in 3.5.1.6.

4.6.3 Dielectric stress.

a. Apply an ac voltage of 2400 volts at 60 Hz for a period of 60 seconds between the instrument's transformer core and the following external parts: case, jaw insulation, trigger, zero adjustment, switch and voltage terminals.

b. Examine the instrument during and after the above tests. There shall be no evidence of arcing, corona, insulation failure or damage.

4.6.3.1 Conductor position effect.

a. Place a conductor, not larger than 0.25 inches in diameter, in the center of the transformer jaws.

b. Apply an ac current of 60 Hz to the conductor, sufficient to produce full scale deflection on one of the current ranges.

c. Shift the conductor position until a maximum variation of indication is obtained.

d. The maximum variation shall not be greater than ± 2.5 percent of full scale.

4.7 Qualification.

4.7.1 Qualification requirements. Prior to actual contract award, all products submitted by any manufacturer shall have passed the qualification tests as specified in Table I, Group A and Group B.

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4.7.2 Qualification test samples. The qualification test samples shall consist of 3 instruments of each type complete with operator's manual and schematic diagram. Samples shall be identified by the manufacturer's own type or model number. The manufacturer shall submit a complete alignment and calibration procedure with each sample. The tests, as sequenced in this specification, do not constitute proper calibration procedures. Qualification test samples shall have been subjected to and have passed the tests as specified in Table I, Group A and Group B, prior to submission of application for qualification testing. The manufacturer shall forward a test report, certified by a registered professional engineer, to the Government with the application, including records of the tests for each unit submitted. These records shall show actual readings taken wherever applicable, rather than check marks indicating conformance.

4.7.3 Equivalent tests. If the manufacturer performs tests equivalent to those specified in 4.6, the test procedures shall be submitted to the Government for approval along with the application for qualification testing. The test procedures shall reference the equivalent test to the applicable requirement specified in 3.5. Further change or amendment to the test procedures by the manufacturer will require resubmittal to the Government for approval and acceptance.

4.7.4 Discontinuance of tests. The Government maintains the prerogative of stopping the qualification testing at any time a test sample fails to meet the specification requirements. Return of the test sample to the manufacturer may be required whenever the Government determines the sample has not complied with the specification requirements.

4.7.4.1 Adjustments during qualification testing. After the qualification tests have started, only adjustments to externally available controls will be permitted.

4.7.5 Resubmission. Samples should not be resubmitted for qualification testing within 6 months following return of the test samples to the manufacturer. Samples may then be resubmitted for qualification testing upon receipt and evaluation by the Government of documented evidence of corrective action. A certified test report, in accordance with the specification requirements in 4.7.2, for all samples to be resubmitted for qualification testing, shall be delivered to the Government prior to resubmission of test articles. These test reports shall include all the tests performed and the test results.

4.7.6 Cost of tests. The Government will be responsible for conducting one qualification test cycle of a particular sample from a supplier at a Government operated or contract laboratory. The cost of additional tests shall be borne by the applicant at an independent laboratory designated by the Government.

4.8 Test method, Group B. The following tests shall be performed in accordance with 4.4 and 4.6.

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4.8.1 Temperature test, nonoperating.

4.8.1.1 Low temperature test. Place the instrument in a temperature test chamber and reduce the temperature of the chamber to minus 54°C. Maintain this temperature for 4 hours. Return the test chamber and instrument to room temperature in 60 minutes. Remove the instrument from the test chamber and immediately perform the test specified in 4.6.2.1. The instrument shall operate within the specified tolerances and there shall be no indication of failure as a result of the low temperature.

4.8.1.2 High temperature test. Place the instrument in a temperature test chamber and elevate the temperature of the chamber to plus 70°C. Maintain this temperature for 4 hours. Return the test chamber and instrument to room temperature in 60 minutes. Remove the instrument from the test chamber and immediately perform the test specified in 4.6.2.1. The instrument shall operate within the specified tolerances and there shall be no indication of failure as a result of the high temperature.

4.8.2 Vibration and shock.

4.8.2.1 Vibration test. The instrument shall be rigidly attached, in the normal operating position, to a vibration testing mechanism. The instrument shall be subjected to a total displacement of 0.01 inches at 10 Hz and 50 Hz for 5 minutes at each frequency. The total displacement shall be vertical (right angles) with respect to the normal operating position of the instrument. At the completion of this test, perform the test specified in 4.6.2.1. The instrument shall operate within the specified tolerances and there shall be no evidence of physical damage or circuitry failure as a result of vibration.

4.8.2.2 Shock. The instrument shall be subjected to the following shock test on a hardwood table top. Using one edge of the instrument as a pivot, tilt the instrument until the horizontal axis of the assembly forms an angle of 45 degrees with the table top or until the elevated edge is 4 inches above the tabletop, whichever occurs first. Allow the instrument to drop freely to the horizontal. Repeat this procedure, using the other edges of the same horizontal face, for a total of 4 drops. At the completion of this test, perform the test specified in 4.6.2.1. The instrument shall operate within the specified tolerances and there shall be no evidence of physical damage or circuitry failure as a result of shock.

4.8.3 At the completion of the above environmental tests, perform all the individual tests as specified in Table I, Group A. The instrument shall operate within the specified tolerances. There shall be no evidence of physical damage or circuitry failure as a result of these tests.

4.9 Inspection of preservation, packaging, packing and marking. The instruments shall be visually inspected to determine compliance with the requirements specified herein with respect to preservation, packaging, packing and marking.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation, packaging, packing and marking.

5.1.1 The equipment, accessories and technical publications shall be preserved, packaged, packed and marked in accordance with MIL-E-17555, level A, B, or C (see 6.2).

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The instruments are intended for use in precision laboratory, field, shop, and depot maintenance applications.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.

b. Type required.

c. Selection of applicable level of preservation, packaging and packing.

6.3 Qualification. With respect to products requiring qualification, awards will be made only for products which are at the time set for opening of bids, qualified for inclusion in the applicable Qualified Products List, whether or not such products have actually been so listed by that date. The attention of the suppliers is called to this requirement, and manufacturers are urged to arrange to have the products that they propose to offer to the Federal Government tested for qualification, in order that they may be eligible to be awarded contracts or orders for the product covered by this specification. The activity responsible for the Qualified Products List is the Service Engineering Division, SANE, Kelly Air Force Base, Texas 78241, and information pertaining to qualification of products may be obtained from that activity.

Custodian:
Air Force - 82

Review Activity:
Air Force - 82

Preparing Activity:
Air Force - 82

Project No. 6625-F257

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SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved Budget Bureau No. 119-R004

INSTRUCTIONS

This sheet is to be filled out by personnel either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity.

SPECIFICATION

ORGANIZATION	CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NO.	QUANTITY OF ITEMS PROCURED	DOLLAR AMOUNT
		$

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES.

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO IF "YES", IN WHAT WAY?

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity)*	DATE

DD FORM 1426
1 APR 63

REPLACES NAVSHIPS FORM 4863, WHICH IS OBSOLETE

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